



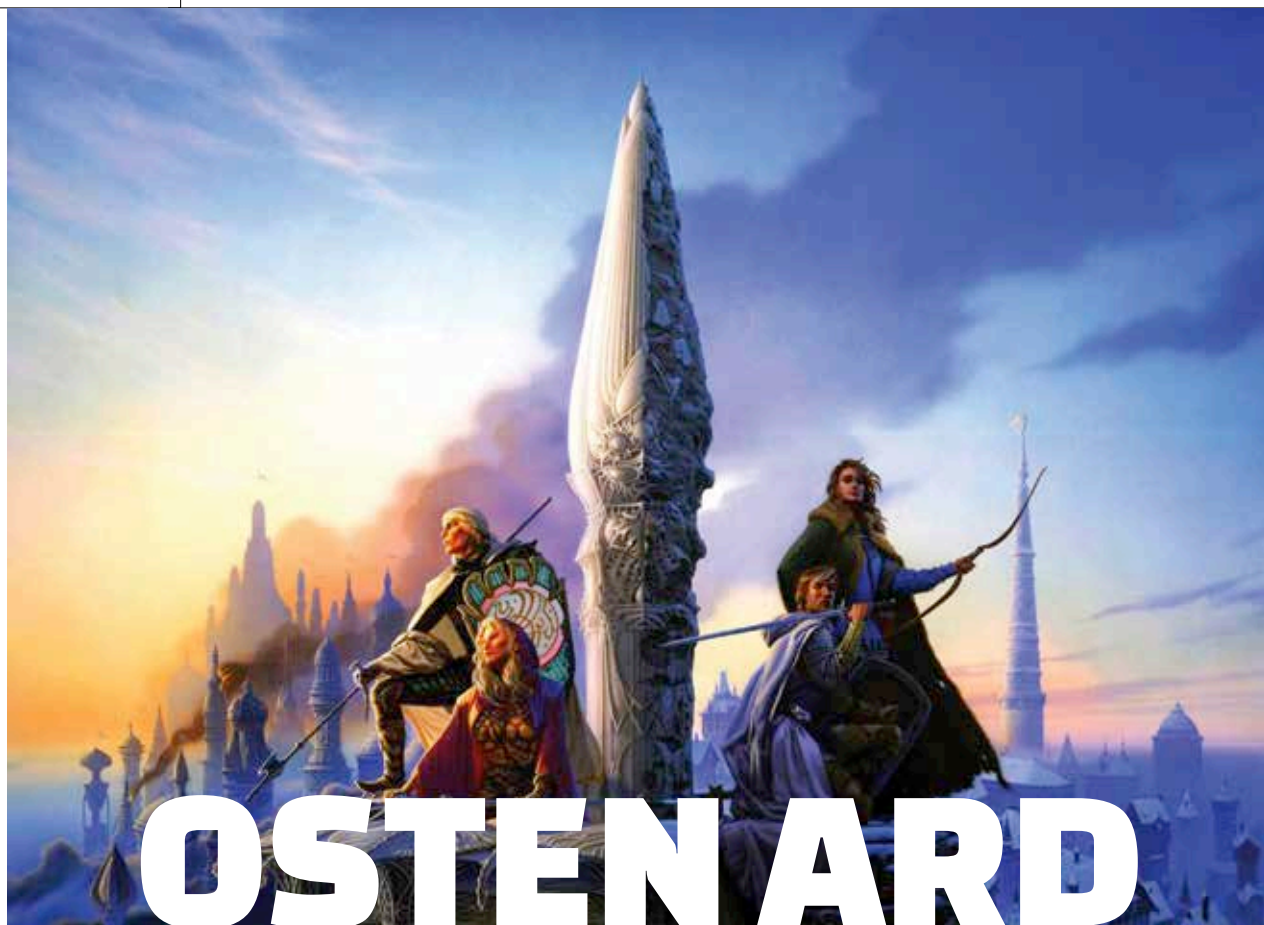
Invincible's missing villains

Amazon Prime's *Invincible* has yet to see these villains from the comics.
<http://digit.in/may21-68>



Demon Slayer movie earnings

Kimetsu no Yaiba - The Movie: Mugen Train has raked in 40 billion yen in Japan.
<http://digit.in/may21-69>



While you wait for *Winds of Winter*, GRRM is impatiently waiting for Tad Williams to finish writing *The Navigator's Children*

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his was a feature meant to be a recommendation for a single book from a fantasy author that

actually delivers on time. *The Navigator's Children*, the third and final book in the *Last King of Osten Ard* series was going to launch in October 2021, but now there is an update from the author, Tad Williams. The book has been delayed, but we are getting another novella. Here, we need to go a bit into the background of what Tad Williams really managed to do with Osten Ard. Osten Ard is a fantasy world in which the

stories written by Tad Williams take place, much like Middle-Earth. The first book, *The Dragonbone Chair* came out in 1988. It was a massive volume where each chapter was told from the perspective of a different character. Towards the worldbuilding and crafting a lived in history for the planet, there were variants of common words used for names of people and things, such as "Ser" instead of "Sir" or "mummer" instead of "actor". If you have been noticing a similarity to another author, yeah, it was *Game of Thrones* (GOT) before *Game of Thrones*, but with far fewer factions and characters. In the early '90s, two other books followed, *The Stone of Farewell*, and *To Green Angel Tower*, this last book is a doorstopper

and a weapon, one of the largest books ever written in the English language, and all of it is one roller-coaster of a joyride. These three books together form the *Memory, Sorrow, Thorn* (MST) trilogy, which was released in 1993. The books were dynamite, and had a seminal influence on the genre of fantasy, but we will come back to that in a bit. In 2017, after a gap of 24 years, Tad Williams revisited this rich world with a new trilogy, called the *Last King of Osten Ard*. The first book in this new series is called *The Witchwood Crown*, the second is *Empire of Grass*, and the third and final one is still being written.

Let us go back to 1993 when the first series were concluded. By then Fantasy had grown rather stale because it was all the variations of the same humans-vs-orcs with elves and dwarves watching story that Tolkien invented. Before Tolkien there was no such thing as fantasy, there were